

Project 3 -

Note-taking

Hotel desktop usability test

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Objectives

- Build your skills in this extremely important research technique
 - Create a bank of insights that will be used during all future projects
 - Photograph and document everything you do to build your portfolio
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Tasks

1. Watch the recordings of two usability tests (for desktop or mobile, depending on which path you've chosen).
2. Take detailed notes. Don't just write down everything the user says and does. Focus on the goals, behaviours, context, positive interactions, and pain points for each participant.
3. Finish with a conclusion on the main points you've learned.

Test 1

Introduction + explanation of set up (person nods in a sign of understanding. Confident tone when confirming understanding).

No questions after the intro.

User's background:

Occupation: Administration manager

Based in: Ireland

Access internet: Home and work. Lunch break mostly at work. PC and phone.

General websites often used: breaking news, adverts, amazon (always).

Hotel booking website (reasons): Going somewhere nice (roughly monthly) with husband and friends. The experience (including dining and staying the night) is very important.

Websites: Booking.com (mostly used) / Tripadvisor (for reviews) / LivingSocial (bad experience)

Booking experiences:

- LivingSocial (get the worst service). Bad experience = Voucher experience (restaurant & hotel).
- Last time booked directly with the hotel - a very easy and clear website. Keen on the add-on.
- The most important criterion for choosing a hotel is: easy to book (book the extras).

Task 1

barcelo.com

Homepage -

G - Find a hotel in Barcelona by the beach

B - Type Barcelona in the search bar

PP - Mention the lack of a map (an important missing feature)

C - Selecting dates

B/PP - Prefer to select dates rather than calendar (the software is forcing her its own way - she no like it)

G/PP - Doing the task again - confusion (more luck than anything)

B/PP - Check-in - No like scrolling prefer calendar (software not friendly)

Homepage/List of Hotels -

B/PI - Looking at page + Tripadvisor reviews (good)

B/PI - Looking at hotel options + Price is clear

C/G - Looking for a map to locate the proximity of the hotel to the beach

B - Found map - click on a hotel near the beach

Hotel 1 -

C - Hotel's first impression by looking at homepage

B/PI - Noticing pictures + reviews (reiterate the importance)

PP - Long description

G/B - Looking for amenities by checking hotel photos

G/B - Photos to understand room size and restaurant (no photos = shady hotel)

C - Normally before selecting a hotel she would compare 2 / 3 hotels at the same time

B/PI - Defo join the membership knowing from previous experience she could get nice deals

Rooms -

G - Finding a suitable room

B/PP - Scrolling down the rooms list (not keen on scrolling down. All in one sheet easier to compare prices).

G/PP - Selected a room - Loading time too long.

Adds on -

G - Looking for breakfast

B/PP - Couldn't see the Breakfast option immediately meaning it was not there.

PP - Attention to little details (important to her)

PP - Double bed (MEGA CONFUSION on what it means)

Extras -

G - Looking for free cancellation

PP - annoyed it hasn't been mentioned anywhere yet. Free cancellation is IMPORTANT

Overall -

PP - A clunky experience.

PP - The booking process is slow and doesn't match her fundamental essential (free cancellation). Chances are she wouldn't book it.

Task 2

Doyle Collection

Homepage -

C - First impression - lovely

C/PI - Pictures make her want to go there

C/PI - The menu shows desirable requirements (restaurant, bar) BOOST THE MOOD

Book a hotel -

C/B - Checked special offers even though she has fixed dates (personality traits?)

PP - Missing guests number (software losing credibility)

Find a room -

C/G - Looking at the page with the option of the room to find a suitable room

B - PICTURES - can really define the size of the room (more than one pic is better)

B - Looking at rooms features - IMPORTANT

B - Rooms size - IMPORTANT (TEAMWORK WITH HUSBAND TO UNDERSTAND MEASUREMENTS)

B/PP - Checking rates - Repetition causes confusion

Adds on -

C - Annoyed they weren't mentioned earlier (the software should be forthcoming)

B/PP - Offers to reflect reality (public transport offer rather than parking)

B/PP - Restaurant - offer reduction

G - Checking if breakfast is included

PP - WHERE IS BREAKFAST?! Hasn't noticed whether it is there or not.

Overall experience -

PI - The layout is better than the other one (resembles the ones she uses).

PP - Too much scrolling.

PP - Clearer info display (breakfast/free cancellation).

PP - Special offers, clarity on dates.

PP - More pictures of the room.

PP - The loading and clunky process when going back to previous pages cause confusion. Everything has to be instant.

Test 2

Intro - set up explanation

No questions prior to testing

Occupation: Account Manager for IT

Based in: Dublin

Access internet: Home + phone (a lot on the net on both devices)

General websites often used: Google, LinkedIn, Booking.com, Airbnb, Shopping, News

Hotel booking website (reasons): Leisure 70% + Business 30%. International traveller.

Websites: Booking.com (mostly due to the Genius option) + Airbnb

Booking experiences: (last time) Birthday, deal at 4 Seasons, included dinner + b&b.

Reason to pick the hotel: Price (quality x money).

Behavior: Compared a few options.

Important factors: ratings/facilities/what's included in the deal.

Overall impression: quick & easy. Reality reflected info and photos on the website.

Test 1

Barcelo.com

Homepage -

B - Straight to search (if knowing what she wants)

G/B - Looking at the dropdown menu for hotels + selecting one of the options

B - Selecting check-in/out

B - Double-check n of guests

Hotel homepage -

C - Expected lists of hotels instead of the hotel itself

B - Noticing Tripadvisor rating - IMPORTANT

B - Looking at pictures slideshow - GOOD FIRST IMPRESSION

G/B - Find map easily MAP POSITION HANDY (MAP IMPORTANT FEATURE)

B/PI - Handy info about the distance from the airport

B - Would look for facilities option (SWIMMING POOL, BAR, AIRPORT CONNECTION)

Back to Homepage -

G/PP - Do Task again - Find a hotel closer to the beach

B/PP - Search in the dropdown menu - CONFUSION

B - Hotel dropdown menu in navbar

C - List of hotels.

B - Picked one with "beach" in the description

C - Hotel description - PHOTOS + FACILITIES + LOCATION + TRANSPORT + CLOSE AMNESTIES (for bit and bobs for the room) - IMPORTANT CHOOSING FACTORS

List of rooms -

G/B - Pictures scroll (to get an idea of the room)

B - Look at rooms details - fridge, coffee machine, hair dryer, aircon/heating, music.

B - Never check the size of the room - ("looks small from pictures")

C/G - Looking for breakfast -

B - click the tab arrow instead of the "go back" option

B - Not bothered about the pop-up window with the Black Friday discount

Calendar - Select dates again

PP - Change dates. Jumpy, not responsive page (PATIENCE LOST)

Room selected -

B/PP - Look at rates options with breakfast included(WOULD PREFER BREAKFAST OPTION TO BE LISTED EARLIER ON)

ADD ON -

PP - Too early in the booking process, it slows it down. (PREFERS ADD-ON AFTER SELECTED ROOM, LOSING PATIENCE).

PP - Double bed - "a bit much"

Overall -

C - Not satisfied -

PP - Breakfast - shown too late

PP - Bed - no clear info on the kind of bed in the room description, hence later confusion and possibly frustration

PP - Important details on amenities and room missing.

Task 2

Doyle Collection

Homepage -

C - IMAGES QUALITY gives a better impression of the hotels'

PP - The menu is hard to see with certain images

PI - Book now button is not easy to locate

PI - Selecting dates + guests

Hotel selection -

PP - too much scrolling - suggested Filter options

C/PP - Having to check each hotel individually for a room

Rooms list -

B/PP - Checking rooms description - can't find twins room (FILTERS MENTION AGAIN)

G/PP - Finding Twin rooms - unclear description or uncertain of the meaning

Room rates -

PP - CONFUSION - two rates look the same. No summary description BUT an option to pay (OVERWHELMING). "This website feels more confusing than the other one"

B/PP - Clicked back to the homepage to find more room rates - redone all processes.

Room photos -

B/PP - Looking at photos. IMPORTANT to have multiple showing different rooms + features + window room (OTHERWISE FEELS CHEATED).

B/PP - Looking at room amenities and details - IMPORTANT to be displayed.

B/PP - Went back to the homepage to look at other hotel options

C/PP - The Marylebone - can't find "book now" button

Extras -

PP - When asked what "Personalize your stay" mean - NO CLUE ON MEANING

Overall -

PI/PP - Look classy but not friendly.

PP - Didn't do the work for her.

PP - Left her with no confidence in the purchase (too few steps).

C/PP - Having a snapshot comparing the three hotels instead of checking each one individually.

PP - Really don't like the dropdown menu in "BOOK YOUR STAY".

PP - The map doesn't show straight away.

PP - Overall feeling - NOT QUITE IN CONTROL OF THE BOOKING.

Conclusion -

- As users have different ways to achieve tasks (i.e. using the calendar VS inserting dates) it would be good for the software to provide multiple options to satisfy everyone.
- Reviews, photos, and maps are essentials.
- Photos help create a hotel's first impression and to a certain extent, it helps the person understand the size of a room.
- It's best to avoid long room descriptions as people might not be bothered to read it through and miss important information, which ultimately might end up in them feeling cheated on.
- Rather, be brief and use a clear format, perhaps icons, to describe the hotel and room's amenities.
- Important information, such as price, free cancellation and breakfast should be listed earlier on and should be visible.
- Clear room descriptions.
- Present add-on once the room has been selected otherwise it might feel pushy and shady.
- Be clever about the add-on, don't just present the standard ones.
- Present a clear summary of the booking repeating all the important info.
- Try to remember the basic pieces of information selected by the guests when they're navigating the website back and forth looking for the perfect room.